

Customer Hardship Policy

Aurora Retail Energy · Rev 4 · AER approved 21 June 2026

1 • Purpose

1.1 This policy sets out the assistance available to residential customers experiencing payment difficulty, and the protections that apply while they engage with us.

Training on this document is mandatory for all customer-facing staff and is refreshed annually. Completion is recorded in the learning management system and reported to the compliance committee quarterly.

2 • Scope

2.1 This policy applies to all residential customers in all jurisdictions in which we retail energy.

Nothing in this document limits a customer's rights under the National Energy Retail Law, the National Energy Retail Rules, or any applicable state instrument. Where this document conflicts with a regulatory obligation, the obligation prevails.

3 • Identifying hardship

3.1 We proactively identify residential customers showing early signs of payment difficulty before disconnection is contemplated.

3.2 Minimum indicators include one or more missed or partial payments occurring within a single billing cycle, a failed direct debit, or information suggesting a change in the customer's financial circumstances.

Where a customer cannot be reached after two attempts on their preferred channel, the account is referred to the specialist team for alternative contact before any further action is taken.

4 • Protections while engaged

4.1 Customers assessed under this policy are treated with respect and without judgement.

4.2 Entry to the program is confirmed in writing on the customer's preferred channel.

4.3 A customer who has entered our hardship program, or who is being assessed for entry, must not be disconnected while they remain in contact and are meeting the terms of any arrangement.

4.4 Debt collection activity and default listing are suspended for customers in the program.

Records generated under this section are retained for seven years and made available to the AER on request. Team leaders review a sample of screening outcomes each month as part of the quality framework.

5 • Assistance we must offer

5.1 Eligible customers must be advised if a lower-cost plan is available for their consumption profile, and moved to it on request at no charge.

5.2 Payment arrangements must reflect the customer's capacity to pay.

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